

Bangladesh Parliamentary Debate

Teacher's Large-Classroom Facilitation Playbook · 45–60 Min Session

 25–45+ Students

 45–60 Minutes

 3v3 BDC Format

 Rajshahi Topics

PHASE 1 (3–5 MIN)

Topic & Roster

Random / Browse 50 Motions

PHASE 2 (10–12 MIN)

Team Caucus Prep

A–R–E–I Case Building

PHASE 3 (25–30 MIN)

Live Debate Stage

8 Speeches + POI Bells

PHASE 4 (5–8 MIN)

Adjudication & Verdict

BDC Rubric & Feedback

Large Group Architecture: Solving the "Spectator Problem"

In a standard debate, 6 debaters speak while 30+ students sit passively. To ensure **100% active participation** across a large class, structure the room into 3 functional tiers:

1. Stage Debaters (6–8 Students)

3 Govt (PM, Minister, Whip) & 3 Opp (LO, Deputy, Whip). Deliver the speeches at the podium facing the room.

2. Bench Caucus Pods (8–14 Students)

Research and strategy caucus. Each bench supports their speakers with Rajshahi evidence and drafts 15s POIs.

3. Student Jury & Adjudicators (All Others)

Audience jury members track clashes on paper and take a before/after shift vote on who won the motion.

Classroom Physical Layout (Smart-TV / Projector Front)

 SMART-TV / PROJECTOR SCREEN (Master Clock & Bells)

 GOVERNMENT BENCH (PM, Minister, Whip + Caucus)

 PODIUM

 OPPOSITION BENCH (LO, Deputy, Whip + Caucus)

 AUDIENCE JURY (Peer Scoring, Clash Tracking & Audience POI Poll)

Phases 1 & 2: Setup & Team Caucus (15m)

- **Select Topic (2m):** Click " Random Topic" or browse categories. Read the motion aloud in English and Bengali.
- **Form Benches (2m):** Split room down the middle (Left = Government, Right = Opposition). Have each side pick their 3 primary speakers.
- **Start 12–Min Prep Timer:** Press "*Start Prep Timer*" on the front screen. The schedule matrix displays all 8 speaking turns.
- **Guide the A–R–E–I Method:**
 - **Assertion:** What is your team's core claim?
 - **Reasoning:** Why is this logically true?
 - **Evidence:** Real Rajshahi context (e.g. RU, Padma, easy-bikes, mango farming).
 - **Impact:** How does this help/harm students?
- **Bell at 2:00 Remaining:** Chime warns teams to finalize speaker handoffs.

Phases 3 & 4: Live Stage & Scoring (35m)

- **Order of Speeches:** 1. PM (Govt) → 2. LO (Opp) → 3. Minister (Govt) → 4. Deputy (Opp) → 5. Govt Whip → 6. Opp Whip → 7. Opp Reply → 8. Govt Reply.
- **Bells & POI Discipline:**
 - **0:00–1:00:** Protected time (No POIs). Single bell at 1:00.
 - **1:00–3:00:** POI Window OPEN! Opponents stand and say "*On that point, Madam Speaker*". Max 15s.
 - **3:00–4:00:** Final min protected. Single bell at 3:00.
 - **4:00:** Double bell (Time up! 20s grace period).
- **Live Rubric Scoring (Teacher):** Adjust the 5 sliders (Logic 35, Evidence 20, Delivery 20, Rebuttal 15, Team 10) during each speech.
- **Announce Winner & Best Speaker:** Reveal Phase 4 scorecard and deliver 3 minutes of constructive feedback.

Bilingual Scaffolding & Classroom Friction Audit

Debate Sentence Starters & Teacher UI Optimization Guide

ESL Support Sheet

🧠 Student Scaffolding: Formal Debate Sentence Starters (Bengali & English)

Speaking Function	English Formula (Say this at the podium)	Bengali Equivalent (বাংলা)
Formal Opening	"Madam Speaker, esteemed adjudicators, and fellow members of the House, good day."	মাননীয় স্পিকার, বিজ্ঞ বিচারকমণ্ডলী এবং উপস্থিত সূত্রীবৃন্দ...
Definition & Context	"To ensure clarity, this House defines the key problem in Rajshahi as..."	বিতর্কের স্পষ্টতার স্বার্থে আমরা সংজ্ঞায়িত করছি...
Presenting Policy Model	"Under our policy model, we implement a practical 3-step mechanism: First..."	আমাদের প্রস্তাবিত নীতিতে তিনটি পদক্ষেপ রয়েছে...
Argument & Evidence (AREI)	"Our primary contention is [Claim]. In Rajshahi, local evidence proves [Evidence], leading to [Impact]."	আমাদের মূল দাবি হলো... স্থানীয় বাস্তব উপাত্ত প্রমাণ করে...
Direct Rebuttal	"The honorable previous speaker argued that [X]; however, this collapses because..."	পূর্ববর্তী সম্মানিত বক্তার যুক্তিটি ধোপে ঢেকে না কারণ...
Point of Information (POI)	"On that exact point: How can you justify the severe cost burden on local students?"	সুনির্দিষ্ট ওই পয়েন্টে: শিক্ষার্থীদের ক্ষতির দায় কে নেবে?
Reply Speech Comparison	"Madam Speaker, this debate comes down to two worlds: in their world... but in ours..."	এই বিতর্কের শেষে দুটি ভিন্ন দৃশ্যপট স্পষ্ট হয়ে উঠেছে...

⚠ Classroom Friction Points Encountered & Teacher Mitigations

During the iterative design of this application, several practical friction points arose between digital UI features and real-world classroom dynamics. Below are the key findings and how the streamlined UI resolves them:

1. Multi-Device Login / Room Friction vs Single Smart-TV

The Problem: When requiring all 35 students to scan a QR code, join isolated rooms, and log into phone workspaces, ~5–10 minutes of class time were lost to Wi-Fi connectivity, phone battery issues, and students getting lost across tabs.

The Solution: Reverted to the *Single-Master Screen Projector Model*. The front screen runs the entire structure (timings, bells, queue). Students turn their desks and collaborate face-to-face with pens, physical placards, and eye contact.

2. On-Screen Scratchpads & Anti-Cheating Insecurity

The Problem: When digital textboxes or scratchpads were projected on the front screen during prep time, teams worried the opposing side would read their arguments or that typing distracted from vocal debate prep.

The Solution: Scratchpads were *completely removed* from the main screen. Instead, the Prep Room displays the *Full 8-Turn Speaking Order Matrix & Exact Durations*, giving students a high-level roadmap to structure their own physical notes.

3. Sound Output & Speaker Bell Audibility in Noisy Classrooms

The Problem: Web Audio API bells playing through laptop speakers are often drowned out by excited students arguing during POI windows.

The Solution: Connect the classroom laptop/Smart-TV to the room PA speaker. If audio is quiet, the UI provides high-contrast visual cues: the stage clock turns cyan during open POIs and pulses yellow/red at the 1-minute warning.

4. Adjudication Slowness Between Back-to-Back Speeches

The Problem: Teachers who wait until after the speech to score struggle to recall specific point breakdowns while introducing the next debater.

The Solution: Sliders are built directly on the live stage view. The teacher adjusts sliders in real-time during the speech. Tapping *"Next Speaker"* automatically archives the current score and loads the next speaker without page reloads.

5. Reply Speech Order Confusion

The Problem: Students often mistakenly assume Government speaks first in reply speeches because they spoke first in substantive turns.

The Solution: The UI enforces authentic Bangladesh parliamentary rules: Turn 7 is automatically locked to Opposition Reply, followed by Turn 8 Government Reply, preventing order mistakes.